Non-ICP flagging rules

Six rules, checked automatically from a company's website. A company is flagged if any one fires. Flags are used to suppress ad audiences and lower lead priority. They do not block anyone from booking a demo.

Rules 5 and 6 were added 2026-09-07, rule 1 was widened at the same time, and an older rule that flagged an individual licensed rep working under a named carrier or brokerage was dropped: an individual realtor now fires the blacklist rule anyway. The rules overlap on purpose. A single-location salon fires two of them, and a flag set is a set, so one flag is enough.

1. Marketing, search or web agency

Fires when the company is an agency or freelancer selling **SEO or AEO/GEO, digital marketing, or website design and build** to clients, whether or not it is their main offer. **Widened 2026-09-07.** The old rule fired only when search was the primary offer, so full-service shops and paid-media-only shops stayed in ICP. They no longer do.

FLAGGED

`austinheaton.com`
SEO and AEO consultancy, search visibility is the whole offer

`navarrocreativegroup.com`
Full-service: web design, SEO, social, PPC. New under the widened rule

`clearsitesystems.com`
Web design shop with SEO as one service among several

`bargainppc.com`
PPC management only, no search offer. New under the widened rule

`beyondthefunnel.ai`
LinkedIn ads specialist. Explicitly kept in ICP before, flagged now

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`thepublive.com`
Content platform sold to publishers. A software business, not an agency

`restaurantspointofsale.com`
Restaurant POS platform. Sells software, not marketing services

A PR-only or branding-only studio

An in-house marketing team at a product company

A print or signage supplier, which rule 6 handles instead

2. Nonprofit

Fires when the company **itself** is a charity funded by donations. Who they sell to is irrelevant. A commercial business whose customers are charities is still a commercial business.

FLAGGED

`hopetowalk.org`
Nonprofit healthcare organisation

`isips.org`
Nonprofit focused on sharps injury prevention

`middletownworks.org`
Nonprofit supporting single-parent families

`cycleconnect.org`
Nonprofit providing farmer financing and training

`globalcodesigns.org`
Community and sustainability nonprofit

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`bgenerous.com`
Lends to 501(c)(3)s. It is a lender, not a charity

`cdsfunds.com`
Fundraising consultancy whose clients are nonprofits

A software vendor selling to charities

A social enterprise trading commercially

A mission-driven for-profit or B-corp

3. Publisher

Fires when the company's **own product is content**, monetised by advertising or subscriptions. Having a blog does not make you a publisher. Selling tools to publishers does not either.

FLAGGED

`savannahmagazine.com`
Magazine and content publishing

`uscybersecurity.net`
Trade magazine funded by subscriptions and ads

`expansionsolutionsmagazine.com`
Magazine and content platform

`highlycapitalized.com`
Industry news and media publication

`allaccess.com`
Music and radio industry news and charts

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`thepublive.com`
Content platform sold to publishers. A software business

A content marketing agency producing work for clients

Any company that runs an active blog

A conference or events organiser

A SaaS product with a media brand attached

4. Ticket under $1,000 a year

Fires when **their own** typical customer, job or order is worth under $1,000 a year, with the evidence quoted from their page. Never inferred from industry. If a company's customer is worth less than $1,000, they need enormous volume before $800–2,200 a month pays back.

FLAGGED

`alwaysazul.com`
Pottery studio. Page shows "$16–$55 per item"

`24light.store`
Consumer goods. Page shows "$3.99–$19.99 range"

`apothecafeinc.com`
Supplements. "$19.99–$29.99, free shipping on $60+"

`airhubapp.com`
eSIM subscriptions. "From $2.99 USD"

`abcdancer.com`
Consumer mobile app on app-store downloads

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`fordhamcapital.com`
Business lender. "$120M funded"

`gglendinggroup.com`
Bridge lender. "$1B+ in closed loans"

`avant-capital.com`
Commercial real estate bridge lender

`garofano.store`
High-value custom furniture and marble goods

`formosaamerica.com`
Custom flexible packaging manufacturer, B2B production runs

5. Local or service-area business

Fires when the business can only serve **one town, a stated travel radius or a named service area**, or serves its customers at its own premises. These buyers are won on Google Business Profile and the local map pack, not on the national organic and AI-search surface the Organic Agent moves. They can afford us; they will not see the lift, and they leave. Judged on how far they can **serve**, never on where they advertise.

FLAGGED

`australhvac.com`
Licensed HVAC contractor, one metro service area

`landscapelightingdesignersplus.com`
Landscape lighting design, DC area only

`factorydirectrenovations.com`
Kitchen and bath remodeller working a local radius

`splurgebakery.com`
Custom bakery. Customers collect from the premises

`carolinetolentino.com`
Solo stylist working out of one Menlo Park salon

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`restaurantspointofsale.com`
POS platform sold to restaurants nationally

`glassdivider.com`
Manufactures for hotels and restaurants, ships anywhere

`formosaamerica.com`
Packaging manufacturer serving national accounts

A firm with one office and clients across the country

A franchisor selling territories nationally

6. Blacklisted industry

Five industries excluded on **retention**, not on close rate: **real estate** (agents, brokerages and property management), **restaurants and food service**, **spas and salons**, **home services and trades**, and **print and sign shops**. Fires on what the company **is**, never on who it sells to. Heavy overlap with rule 5 is expected and fine: most of these businesses are also local, and a flag set is a set.

FLAGGED

`serhant.com`
Luxury residential brokerage. Real estate, whatever the size

`elliman.com`
Multi-agent brokerage with a global luxury portfolio

`mycosmeticsolutions.com`
Permanent makeup and cosmetic treatment studio

`delarosaroofingllc.com`
Licensed roofing contractor, residential and commercial

`catalogkings.com`
Commercial print shop running catalogues and flyers

NOT FLAGGED BY THIS RULE

`reputesync.com`
Review management built for restaurants. A software business

`bridgeloanscap.com`
Lends against real estate. It is a lender

`rejuvitae.com`
Supplies aesthetic technology to clinics, is not a clinic

`uncledanconsulting.com`
Tax credit consultancy whose clients are restaurants

`formosaamerica.com`
Packaging manufacturer, not a print shop

One bucket, two kinds of evidence

> **Everything a rule flags is non-ICP, full stop.** But the rules were not arrived at the same way, and that matters when you go to check whether one is earning its place. Rules 1 to 4 turn on competitive overlap and deal size, and were validated against closed business: sector on its own did not predict who closes, so none of them fires on a sector label alone.
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> Rules 5 and 6 turn on whether the Organic Agent can move the surface that actually feeds the business. A one-town contractor and a single-location salon grow on the local map pack; national organic and AI-search visibility is not their channel, so they buy, see nothing, and leave. **Score those two on retention and refund rate, not on close rate.** It would not be surprising if the group they flag closes perfectly well. That is what they were added to prevent.

Where e-commerce, app installs and self-checkout land

None of these are industries we exclude. All three are decided by the **ticket rule**, and only the ticket rule.

Business type	How it is treated
E-commerce	Flagged only if the typical order is under $1,000. A $20 average order is out. A furniture or equipment retailer selling $5,000 orders stays in, unless it is a single shop serving walk-in customers, which rule 5 catches.
App installs	Almost always flagged, because consumer app subscriptions fall well under $1,000 a year. It is the ticket that disqualifies them, not the app.
Self-checkout / self-serve	**Not a disqualifier on its own.** We tested a self-serve rule and dropped it, because it caught high-ticket businesses that happen to sell online. A self-serve business whose customer is worth $5,000 a year stays in.

What we deliberately do not flag

Industry on its own, outside the five	Tested across thousands of demos. Sector did not predict who closes. The five in rule 6 are excluded on retention evidence, not on close rate, and no sixth industry gets added without the same case.
Solo operators	In ICP. Solo recruiters and independent consultants perform in line with the average.
B2B software	Core ICP. Only low-ticket consumer products are excluded, via the ticket rule.
Insurance, mortgage and lending	All of it stays in, down to the individual State Farm agent and the solo loan officer. A rule used to take those out on the grounds that a licensed rep under a carrier has no budget authority; it was dropped 2026-09-07. Only the sub-$1,000 ticket (rule 4) excludes anyone here now. Real estate no longer belongs on this row: it left under rule 6.
PR, branding and creative studios	In ICP, as long as they do not sell search, digital marketing or websites. The moment they do, rule 1 fires.
Companies that sell to a flagged industry	In ICP, always. A restaurant POS platform, a lender secured on property and a supplier to med-spas are all ordinary B2B companies. Every rule asks what the company is, never who its customers are.

How it runs

1. **Capture.** The company domain comes from the landing page form. A lead with a free email address and no website is flagged straight away as having no identifiable company.
2. **Enrich.** The site is scraped and read by a language model, which reports what it observes: what the business is, who it sells to, how it sells, how far it can serve, and any pricing it can find, with the exact phrase quoted.
3. **Decide.** The six rules are applied in code from those observations, not asked of the model. The model reports; the rules judge. That keeps every flag auditable and lets us change a rule without re-reading a single website.
4. **Apply.** Flagged companies are excluded from ad audiences first, because that is where suppression is cheapest and stops the spend at source. Then lead routing, so flagged leads go to a lighter-touch flow. Then reporting, so we can see which campaigns and creatives attract them. Never at the booking form.
5. **Monitor.** A sample of flagged companies is hand-checked every week, and ICP share is tracked by campaign. If accuracy drifts, the rules are revalidated before anything is re-run.

Not yet in the numbers

> **Rules 5 and 6, and the widened rule 1, currently flag nobody.** They read four observations the model was not asked for until now: how far the business can serve, whether customers come to its premises, which of the five industries it belongs to, and which marketing services it sells. The 3,165 domains already classified were read under the old questions, so those fields are simply absent and the new rules return false on every one of them. That is silence, not a clean bill of health. Every count and chart still reflects the old rules until a fresh sweep is run over the cached page text.
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> For scale: a crude keyword scan of those 3,165 domains puts **561** of them in reach of the new rules, on top of the **272** that the surviving old rules still flag. Dropping the licensed-rep rule un-flagged 61 companies on its own, 29 of which the blacklist rule will pick straight back up once it can see the industry field. Treat that as an upper bound rather than a count. The scan cannot tell a roofing contractor from a company that sells to roofing contractors, and a visible share of what it caught was the second kind: a restaurant POS platform, a supplier of salon equipment, a packaging manufacturer. Only the model pass can separate them.